What's Different Since Mom Was Approved?

A worksheet for writing down what has changed, and the question each change leaves you with.

The application described Mom's situation as it was that month. A few things may be different now: another room, a closed account, a small check from an old policy. Anything that differs from what the application described belongs on this page, whether it changed before the approval letter came or after.

Take each area in turn. Write what changed, when, and who in the family knows about it. If nothing has changed, write “no change that we know of”. If nobody has looked, write “haven't checked” and leave it.

Don't try to work out whether a change matters or needs to be reported. That varies by state and by case, and it is a question for the Medicaid agency or your Medicaid planner. This page only gets the change written down.

Her income

What comes in each month, and whether any of it has started, stopped or changed. Write what you saw on a statement or a letter, with its date.

FOR EXAMPLE Her pension deposit looked different on the March statement. Don't know why. Haven't asked anyone.

Her accounts and what she owns

Accounts opened or closed, property sold or put up for sale, and any money that arrived outside her usual income, such as an inheritance, a gift, or a payment from a sale or an insurance policy.

FOR EXAMPLE A check came from an old insurance policy in April. Karen has it. Nobody has asked anyone about it yet.

Where she lives and her care setting

A move, a different room or unit, a change from one kind of care to another, or a change in who is at home.

FOR EXAMPLE Moved from the rehab wing to the long-term care wing on the 12th. The business office knows. We haven't told anyone else.

Anything else that's different

A change in marital status if that applies, a new mailing address, someone new handling her money or her mail, or anything you weren't sure where to put.

FOR EXAMPLE Mom's mail has gone to David's house since February. Not sure which address the Medicaid agency has.

The question each change leaves

For each change above, write the question it leaves and who you'd take it to: the Medicaid agency, your Medicaid planner, or “not sure”.

FOR EXAMPLE Does the agency need to hear about the move to the long-term care wing, and how do we tell them? Ask the caseworker.

Who filled this in, and on which date

What this shows you

Three things: what is different from what the application described, when it changed, and the question each change leaves. It doesn't show whether a change has to be reported or whether it affects Mom's Medicaid, and nothing here adds up to a score or a level. Those answers come from the Medicaid agency and from a professional who knows your state's rules. Nothing on this page is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You've written down what is different and the question each change leaves. The planning interview picks up from there: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for Mom's care.

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